

Note to readers: Because of the impending storm, we are printing the Sunday edition early. Some editions may be delivered Saturday evening, while others may be delayed until conditions allow for safe delivery.

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

RE V1 V2 V3 V4

 Cloudy, cold 25/18 • Tomorrow: Snow, sleet 27/33 **B18** Democracy Dies in Darkness SATURDAY, JANUARY 24, 2026 • \$4

Europeans see lesson as Trump backs down

Standing up to him works, officials say after his Greenland reversal

BY ELLEN FRANCIS

BRUSSELS — After President Donald Trump used his bully pulpit in Davos, Switzerland, to demand “the acquisition of Greenland by the United States — just as we have acquired many other territories throughout our history” — and then backed down on the same day, many officials here see a lesson for the European Union: Pushing back works.

The brazen ultimatum — give up Greenland or face tariffs — elicited a level of unity that largely had eluded the leaders of the 27-nation E.U. in the year since Trump’s second inauguration.

Trump’s gambit for Greenland, an autonomous territory of NATO ally Denmark, bonded some unlikely partners in opposition: Europe’s mainstream political establishment with populist and nationalist parties; Republicans and Democrats in the deeply partisan U.S. Congress; the mostly Indigenous people of Greenland with their Danish former colonizers; and the E.U. and Britain, the only country ever to quit the bloc.

For advocates of taking a tougher line with Trump, the president’s climbdown regarding the strategic Arctic territory was proof that retaliation — not conciliation — is the answer to his hardball tactics. After accommodating Trump on trade and on arming Ukraine, the Europeans finally stood up to him. Even

SEE EUROPE ON A14

A modest plan to save Dulles people movers: Call them DJTs

BY RACHEL WEINER

How to save the much-derided people movers at Dulles International Airport? Rebrand them as “Direct Jet Transports.” Or, for short, “DJTs.”

That’s one of the proposals submitted for improving Dulles after President Donald Trump called the airport “a great building and a bad airport,” in December. And it’s received support from Susan Saarinen, daughter of Eero Saarinen, who designed Dulles and the wheeled conveyances that have served the airport since it opened in 1962.

“It’s a name that fits,” Susan Saarinen said in an interview, laughing. “Mr. Trump would like to name the airport after him, because he likes his name I guess, and he likes to name things. And if a DJT happens to work for that, it works for me.”

After Trump’s comments, Transportation Secretary Sean P. Duffy put out a call for ideas to improve the airport with a deadline of Jan. 20. He specifically criticized the mobile lounges, which were involved in two recent accidents, saying the admin-

SEE DULLES ON A10



STEPHEN MATUREN/GETTY IMAGES

A throng of protesters in subzero temperatures take part in a Minneapolis rally Friday against federal immigration enforcement. The day of action pulsed through houses of worship and even the area’s airport, where about 100 clergy were arrested at a peaceful sit-in.

ICE staff reported death of restrained man as a suicide

911 calls add to questions over Texas incident ruled a homicide in autopsy

BY DOUGLAS MACMILLAN

As staff tried to resuscitate Gerardo Lunas Campos at an immigrant detention camp in El Paso, a security contractor called 911, urgently asking for help, according to a recording of the call obtained by The Washington Post through a public records request.

During that call and another 911 call placed after Lunas Campos was pronounced dead, detention center employees told dispatchers the detainee had tried to hang himself — an account that appears to conflict with the medical examiner’s recent finding of a “homicide” while being re-

strained by guards.

Paul Walden, a lieutenant at the Camp East Montana detention center, called 911 at 9:37 p.m. on Jan. 3, saying that Lunas Campos had “tried to hang himself, then we put him in custody, kept going.”

EMS was dispatched for an “apparent suicide” and arrived at 9:48 p.m., according to the El Paso Fire Department’s incident report. Emergency responders were led to Lunas Campos, who “was found pulseless & apneic on the floor of his cell with 2 staff members providing CPR.”

At 10:38 p.m., Daniel Rios, a deputy facility director, asked 911 operators to send a police detective to investigate a “suicide” that had occurred within the preceding 30 minutes. On the call, Rios said he was still on his way to the scene.

“I don’t have the details. I have

SEE DEATH ON A15

Contractor is indicted in leak case tied to Post reporter

Md. man charged with six counts of mishandling classified information

BY PERRY STEIN

A grand jury in Maryland indicted a federal contractor accused of leaking classified information to a Washington Post reporter, charging him with one count of retaining and five counts of sharing sensitive national security information.

The systems administrator in Maryland, 61-year-old Aurelio Luis Perez-Lugones, has held a top-secret security clearance since at least 1995, according to the indictment. He is accused of accessing classified documents from his workplace, printing them out and illegally removing

the materials from secured facilities, according to the indictment, filed in Maryland federal court Thursday.

He faces up to 10 years in prison if convicted.

“Perez-Lugones allegedly printed and removed classified documents from his workplace on multiple occasions, took them home, and later passed them to a reporter who used the information in news articles,” FBI Director Kash Patel said in a statement. “Protecting our country’s secrets is essential to the safety of our most sensitive intelligence, military, and law enforcement operations.”

The investigation of Perez-Lugones led authorities to execute a search warrant last week at the Virginia home of Washington Post reporter Hannah Natanson and seize her electronic devices. A search of a journalist’s home

SEE CONTRACTOR ON A8

Anti-ICE protests escalate in Minn.

THOUSANDS MARCH; BUSINESSES CLOSE

Show of dissent is largest vs. immigration policies

This article is by Lauren Kaori Gurley, Justine McDaniel, Natalie Allison, Michelle Boorstein and Ben Brasch

MINNEAPOLIS — Thousands of people converged at a downtown park on Friday afternoon in the state’s biggest show of opposition yet to the Trump administration’s immigration operations in Minnesota, braving subzero temperatures and skipping work and school.

Hundreds of businesses in the Twin Cities closed for the day of action, an effort organized by faith leaders and labor unions amid continuing tensions over U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement actions in the state, including the fatal shooting of Renée Good by an ICE officer earlier this month.

On Friday morning, about 100 clergy members were arrested at a peaceful sit-in at Minneapolis-Saint Paul International Airport protesting deportation flights. Labor leaders said more than 15,600 people had claimed tickets to the 2 p.m. march in Minneapolis — where the National Weather Service warned of minus-50 degree wind chill through Sunday morning.

Bundled in down coats, beanies and ski goggles, demonstrators chanted “What do we want? ICE out!” and held signs bearing slogans such as “No MN Nice for ICE” and “Leave Us Alone!” as they marched peacefully.

“This rally says it all. We’re fighting for truth and freedom,” said Mary Turner, a night-shift nurse in Robbinsdale, Minnesota, and a union member who joined the march.

Residents opposed to ICE’s actions in Minnesota say federal agents have gone far beyond their

SEE MINNEAPOLIS ON A7

Richmond, D.C. among cities set to bear brunt of storm

Devastating swath of ice could cause long-lasting outages for millions

BY BEN NOLL

The United States is bracing for one of its most widespread winter storms in years, which began Friday.

Around 205 million people across the country are under winter weather alerts for snow, ice or extreme cold ahead of the forming tempest.

The storm’s journey will take four days as it developed over the Rockies and Plains on Friday and will depart the Northeast on Monday night.

Over those four days, a destructive swath of ice will hit dozens of cities in a stretch from northern Texas to southern Virginia, with

the likelihood of tree damage and long-lasting power outages. North of there, a corridor of 10 to 20 inches of powdery snow will pile up from Oklahoma to Maine, making some roads impassable and causing significant disruptions to daily life.

In between those zones, there will be a mix of snow, sleet and freezing rain — this area includes D.C. and the Mid-Atlantic, where shoveling will be tougher because of the crusty layer of ice that forms on top of the snow.

And across the Upper Midwest, wind chills Friday dipped to minus-40 to minus-55 degrees Fahrenheit — which can cause frostbite in minutes. Around 120 million people across the country are forecast to experience subzero temperatures through Wednesday.

SEE STORM ON A4

FEMA: DHS pauses job cuts as winter storm grips U.S. **A5**

IN THE NEWS

Russia doesn’t budge Moscow maintained its hard line on Ukraine, saying it will keep fighting until it gets the territory it wants. **A13**

Slavery exhibits removed National Park Service employees took down signage at Philadelphia’s Independence Park in compliance with a Trump executive order. **A9**

THE NATION An attorney for murder suspect Brendan Banfield told jurors police rushed to judgment. **A10** **Trump** rescinded his invitation to Canada’s prime minister to join his Board of Peace. **A13**

THE WORLD China seeks wider Arctic influence, analysts say, but has no plans to conquer Greenland. **A12** **One Oscar** nominee is among four submitted films about the Israeli-Palestinian conflict. **A14**

THE ECONOMY TikTok says a U.S. spin-off is finalized, allowing Americans continued access to the popular app. **A18** **Check out** our four takeaways from a new Academy of Pediatrics report on children’s screen time on digital devices. **A18**

STYLE What Hollywood tells us about Greenland: The films often look past the people to tell tales of imperialism and strategy. **B1** **The image** of a 5-year-old child detained by ICE in Minnesota is powerful, but can it change anything? **B1**

SPORTS The U.S. Olympic effort was flagging after the 1988 Winter Games. Then George Steinbrenner stepped in. **B7**

THE REGION Maryland dad Harold Simmons II earns a Grammy nomination with his 8-year-old daughter, Aura. **B13**

BUSINESS NEWS.....A18
COMICS.....B4
OBITUARIES.....B17
OPINION PAGES.....A16
TELEVISION.....B6
WORLD NEWS.....A12

CONTENT © 2026
The Washington Post
Year 149, No. 54471

